

I'LL BE BACK...

Disrupter: Robots, or humans

Disrupted: Manufacturing

What Year: 2022 to 2027

This one's a toughie. We are officially sitting on the fence, and we refuse to budge. Call us whatever names you want to, we're going to paint both pictures and give you the tough job of choosing whichever one you deem to be the more likely future.

ROBOTS ARISE!

As big data is more pervasive about everything, and as sensors give computers more fine data to process and understand, the machines will get smarter. Whether they will attain sentience is stuff that we leave for sci-fi writers to discuss, but we're all in agreement that they will get wiser. They say with age comes experience and wisdom, and robots (or machines in general) will have more and more data to work with and draw conclusions from. With sensors going everywhere, and reporting everything, robots will be able to make fine adjustments that humans just cannot – if you can't see at a microscopic level, you can't adjust anything at that level either.

Think F1-level sensors and computations being done for your Maruti! Surely performance will increase in every aspect. Now apply that to all manufacturing, and you will arrive at perfectly designed

everything, made to precision by robots. As we demand more and more from our products, with them getting ever smaller and complex, can anything but robots build any of the things we want anyway?



Industrial robots are evolving

ROBOTS FALL

The flip-side is that there are just too many humans. In the end, it all boils down to money. Currently, robots are cheaper for specific tasks that are repetitive and need high precision.

Now it is possible that the prosumers will end up making (3D printing) their own stuff, leaving the regular folk to pay for factory made things. With so many

humans on the planet, and the number only growing, it's not hard to imagine the costs of semi-skilled and skilled labour going down (relatively speaking). If the free internet projects take off, and more and more people get access to technology, there will be an abundance of labour, all willing to work for cheaper than the costs of setting up robot factories.

Besides, the envelope is being pushed in every field. Take the humble fan for example. Yes, the table fan. As anyone with kids will tell you, it's a nightmare trying to keep toddlers from sticking their fingers in the fan to touch the blades. Thus, the bladeless fan was invented. Then LEDs added, and they became a fashion statement. Traditional fan makers, have to start adding colours, and change the shape of blades, or add LEDs, automatic timers, sensors to prevent over-heating, etc. The days of design once and forget are long gone, and people want to follow fads. All this constant change means that robots become too expensive to keep reprogramming, and people are just easier to re-train. This is the main reason why we feel that there just will be no space for robots in almost all of the world, barring a few underpopulated countries.

UNDER THE BRIDGE

Disrupter: Trolls

Disrupted: Everything

What Year: 10,000 BC to tomorrow (we can hope)

When talking about disruption, it seems a little obvious to mention trolls. They live to disrupt. They thrive on chaos. It's the internet version of vandals and arsonists, looking to laugh maniacally as everything is smashed and burned to the ground.

"Catch them, line them up, and execute the lot!", some would scream. "Off with their heads!", screams another victim. However,

we'd rather stay their execution for now. See, we are firm believers that trolls are a necessary evil for society to improve itself. It's important for people to get their buttons pushed, and to explode every now and then, and then realise that what they did was idiotic. Some believe that reacting to trolls shows thin skin, and a weak character. What trolls do is toughen you up and make you thick skinned,

which in turn makes you more mature. However, not all trolls are just pointless hate spewing machines. The definition of troll itself is different for different people. One person's troll is another's brutally honest commentator who just happened to get under your thin skin.

We believe that trolls will drastically change society for the better in the near future, mainly because they... 